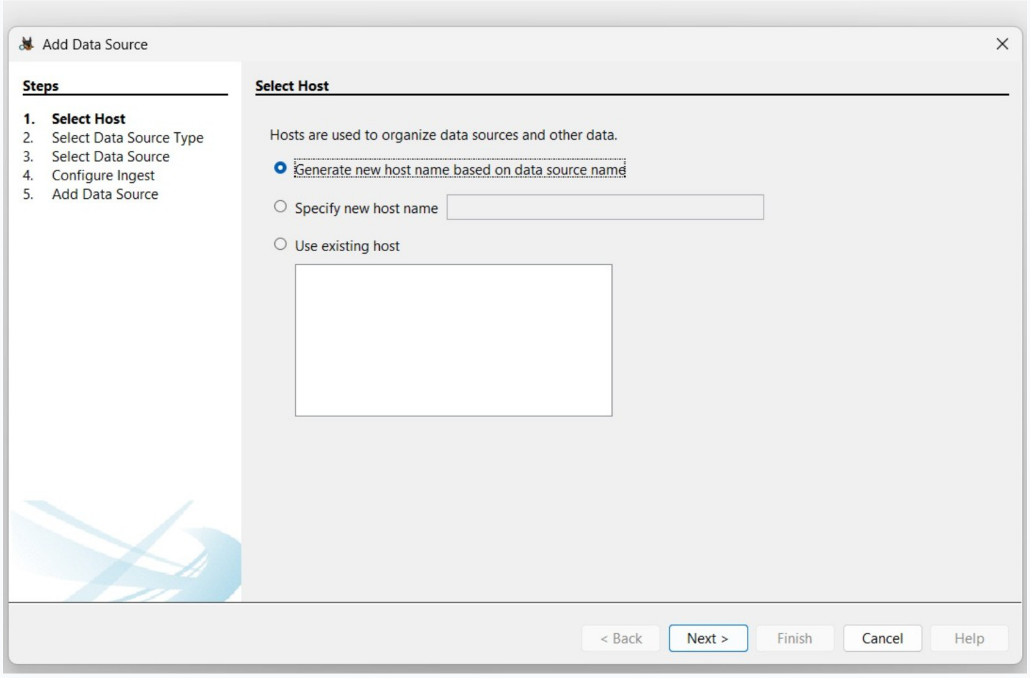
Ex.No.05 - Use Autopsy to Create a Case and Import Evidence

Experiment Name	Use Autopsy to Create a Case and Import Evidence
Aim	To use Autopsy to create a forensic case and import digital evidence for analysis.
Tool Used	Autopsy
Evidence Used	4Dell Latitude CPi.E01, 4Dell Latitude CPi.E02

Experiment Focus: Case creation, evidence import, ingest configuration, timeline analysis, and HTML report generation using Autopsy.

Output 1 - Autopsy Welcome / Start New Case

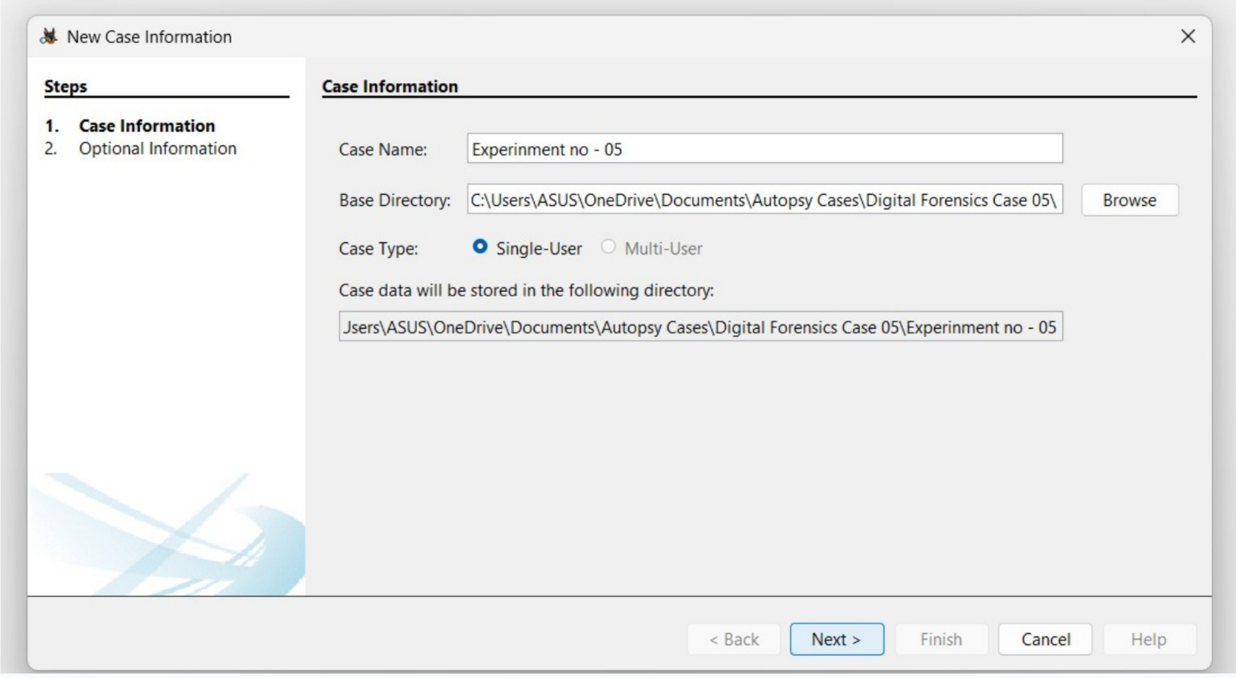


This screen initiates the **Autopsy** evidence workflow. A new forensic case is started here before evidence is connected to a host, allowing the investigation to be organised within a dedicated case structure.

Forensic significance: This first output establishes the investigation workspace. In a forensic examination, starting with a dedicated case helps separate one evidence set from another and provides a controlled location for subsequent source registration and analysis.

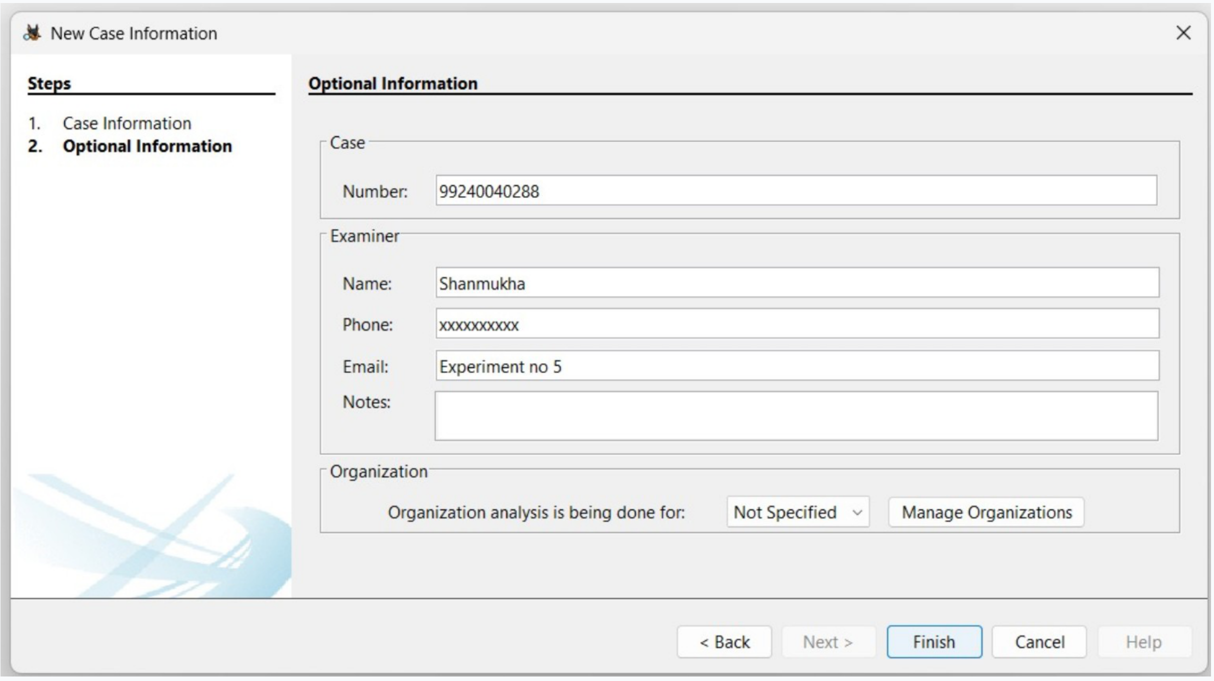
Key terms: Autopsy, forensic case, digital evidence, host, data source, evidence processing.

Output 2 - New Case: Case Information



The Case Information window records the essential identity of the **forensic case**, including the case name, base directory, and case type. These details establish the storage location and administrative structure for the investigation.

Output 3 - New Case: Optional Information



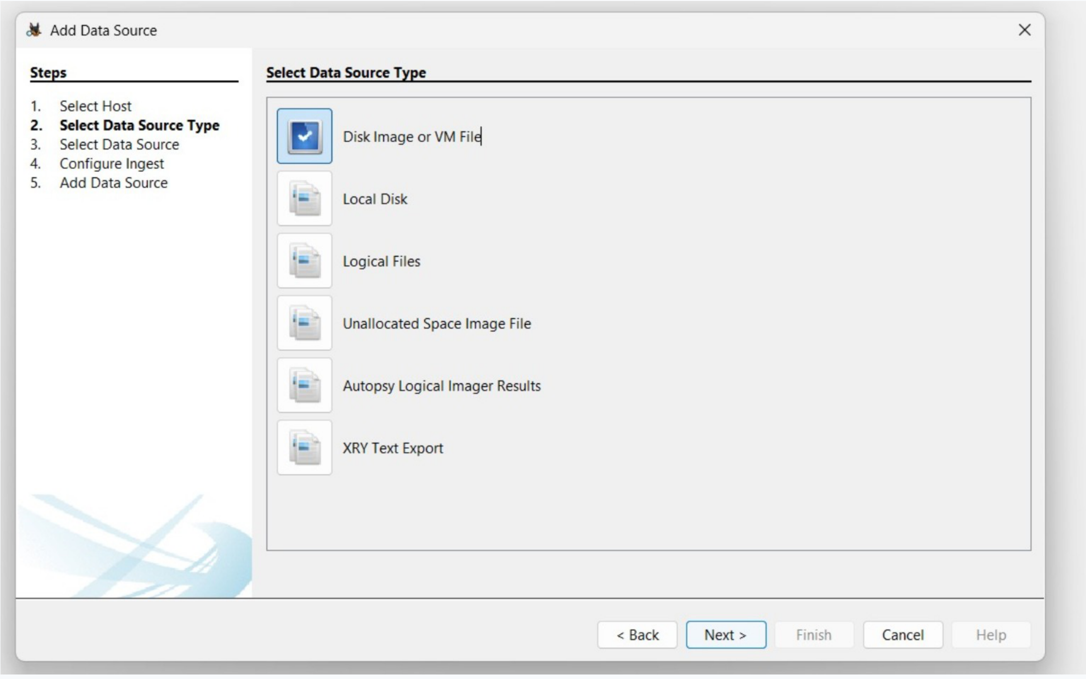
The Optional Information stage captures examiner and case metadata such as the case number, examiner name, contact details, and notes. Accurate metadata improves traceability and provides clear documentation for the digital evidence examination.

Forensic significance: Case identity is important because every later result should be traceable to the correct investigation. The case name, directory, and user mode shown here provide a clear administrative foundation for evidence handling. Metadata recorded at this stage supports accountability. Examiner information and case identifiers help connect the evidence processing activity to the documented investigation and make the resulting report easier to audit.

Output 4 - Add Data Source: Select Host

The Select Host stage associates the incoming evidence with an investigation host. This provides Autopsy with a logical organisation point before the **data source** is selected and processed by the forensic analysis workflow.

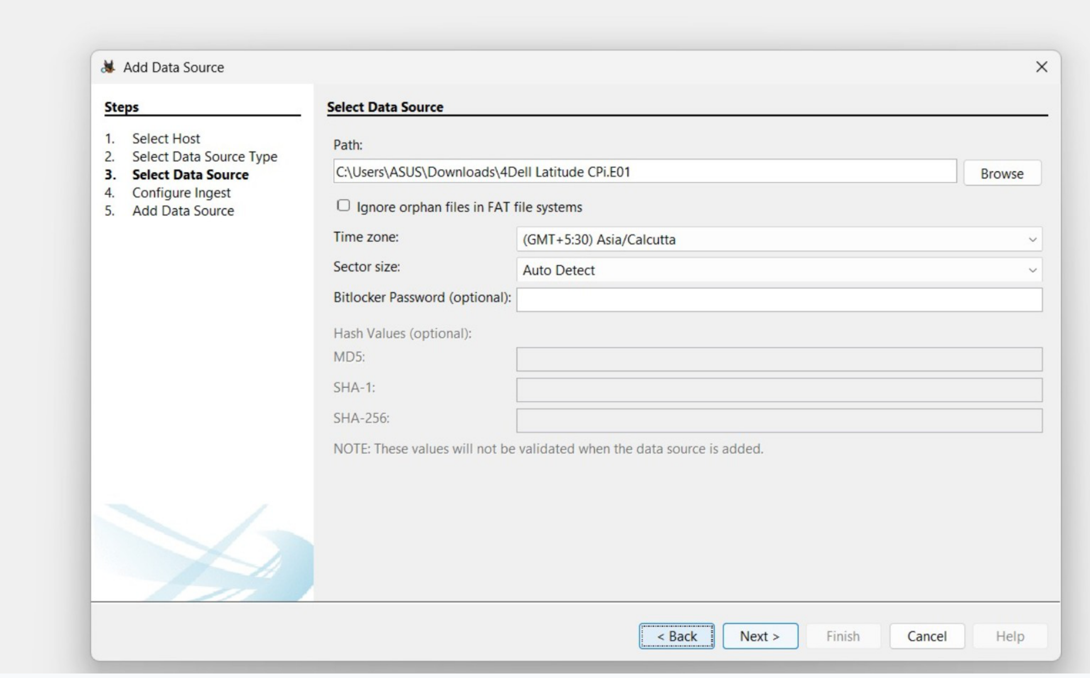
Output 5 - Add Data Source: Select Data Source Type



The Select Data Source Type screen identifies the format of the evidence being imported. In this experiment, **Disk Image or VM File** is used so that the supplied forensic image can be analysed within the case.

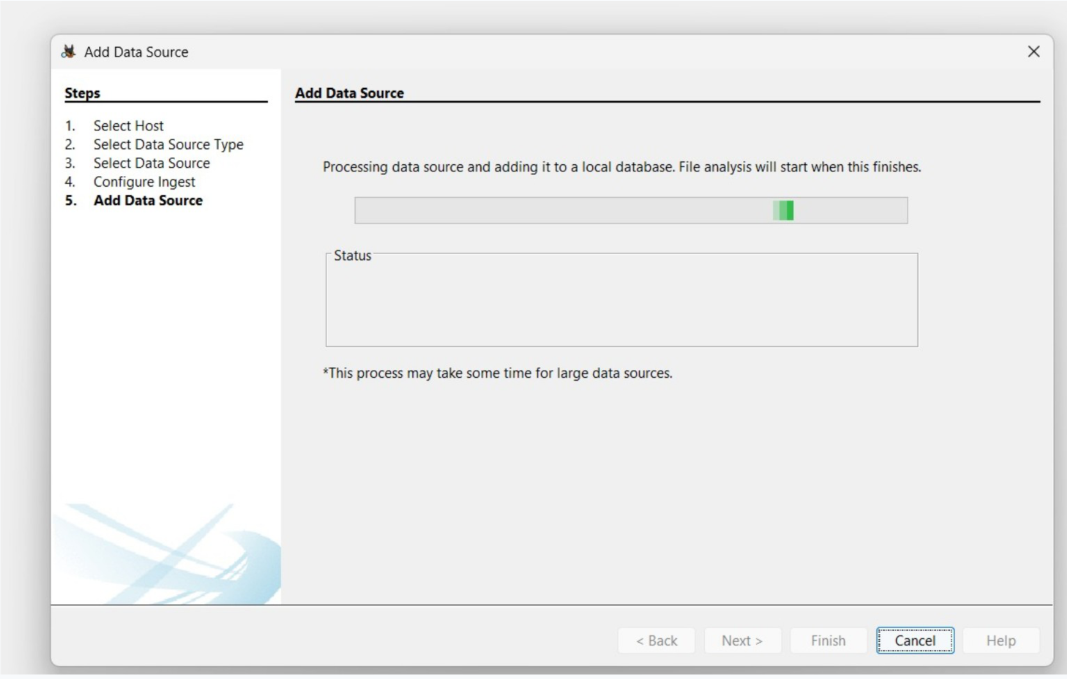
Forensic significance: Host association keeps the evidence logically organised. It also reduces ambiguity when multiple data sources are examined within the same forensic case or when results are reviewed later from report navigation. Selecting the correct source type is essential because Autopsy uses the source format to determine how the evidence should be interpreted. The screen shown here confirms the image-based forensic workflow used for the experiment.

Output 6 - Add Data Source: Select Data Source



The Select Data Source window specifies the evidence image path together with acquisition-related settings such as time zone and sector size. These parameters help Autopsy interpret and process the imported **digital evidence** consistently.

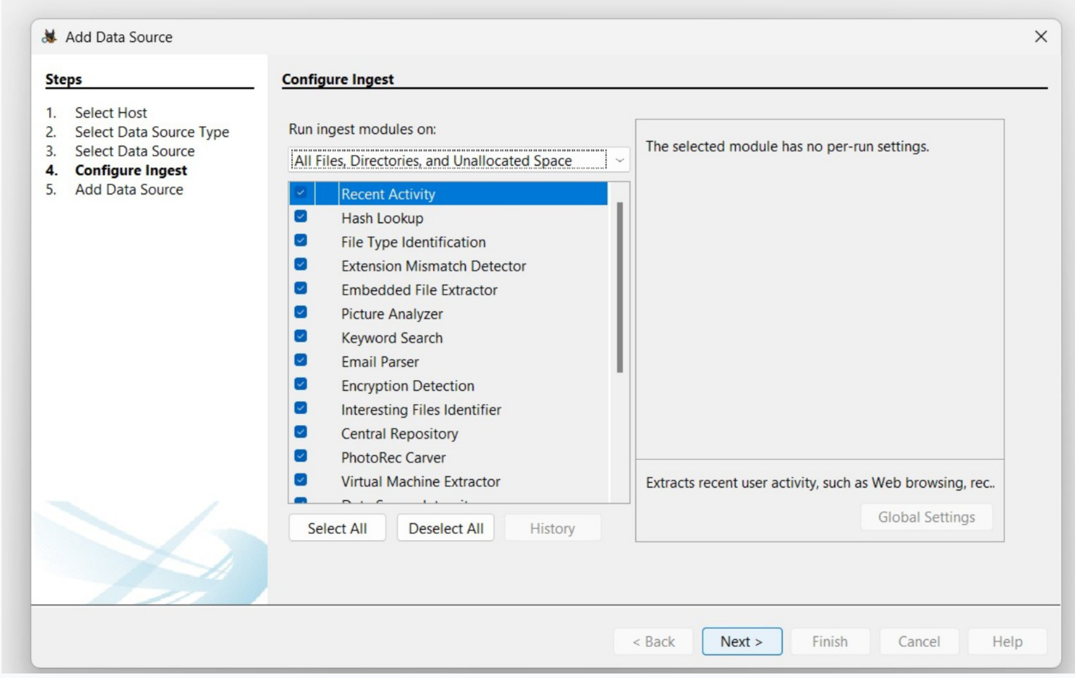
Output 7 - Add Data Source: Configure Ingest



The Configure Ingest stage controls the forensic processing modules. Functions such as Recent Activity, Hash Lookup, File Type Identification, Keyword Search, Email Parser, and Encryption Detection help extract and classify relevant artefacts.

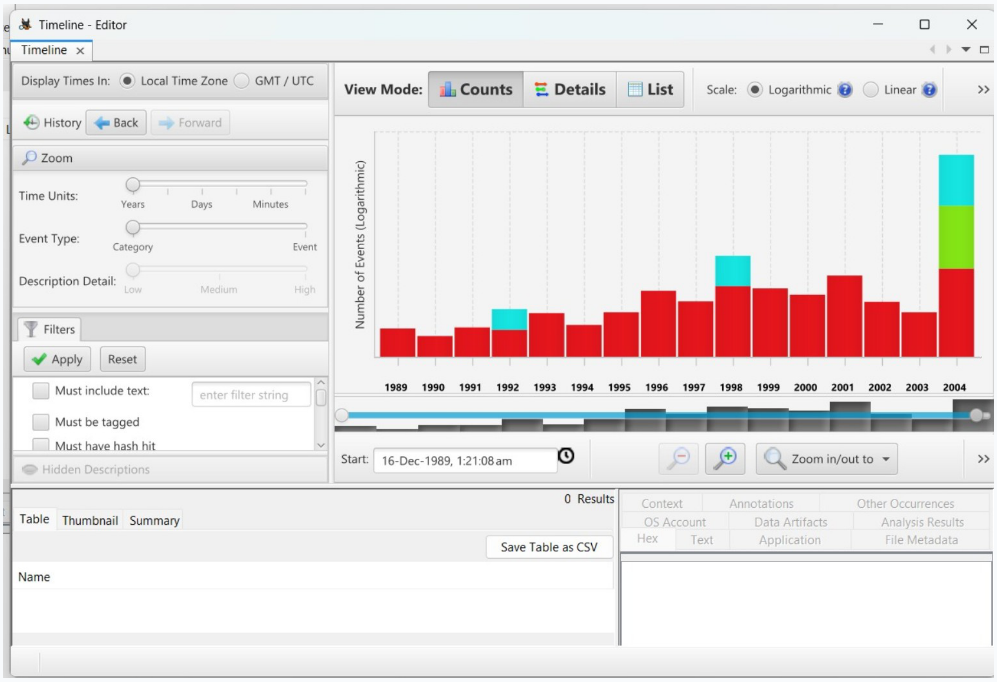
Forensic significance: Accurate source configuration contributes to reliable analysis. The image path and interpretation settings are recorded before ingest so that the processing stage works on the intended evidence source. Ingest configuration determines what information Autopsy attempts to extract. Using several complementary modules increases the range of artefacts available for timeline correlation, keyword review, and other forensic analysis activities.

Output 8 - Add Data Source: Processing / Data Source Added



The Add Data Source stage confirms that the evidence is being processed and added to the local case database. Once processing begins, the selected ingest modules analyse the data source and prepare artefacts for later examination.

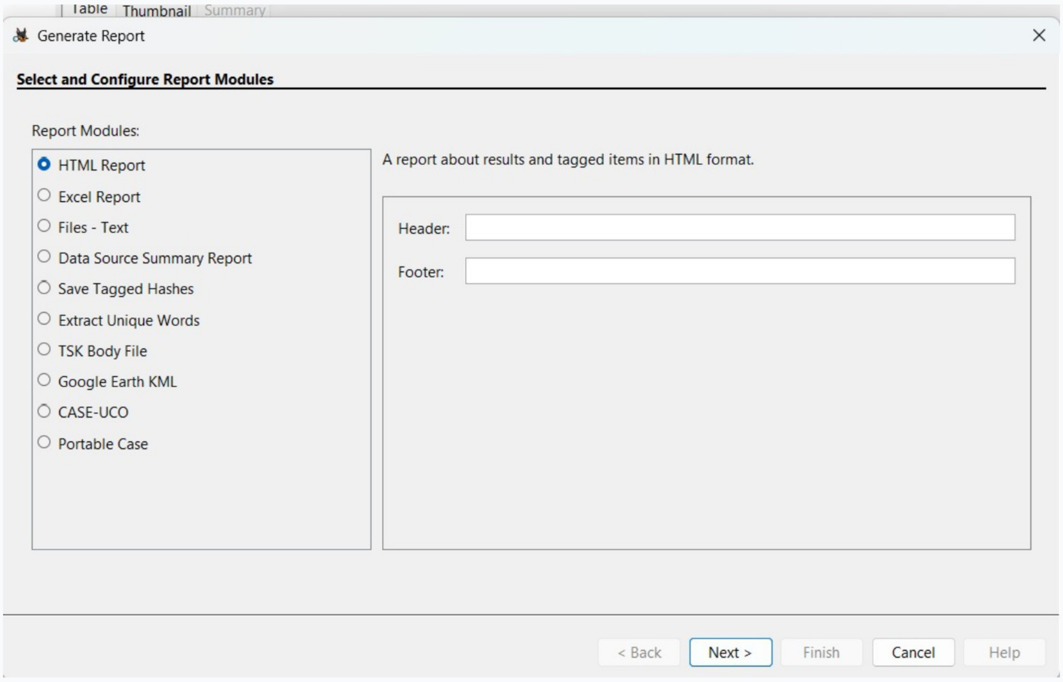
Output 9 - Timeline Analysis



Timeline Analysis provides a chronological view of activity recovered from the processed evidence. Event counts, time ranges, filters, and detail views can be used to correlate activity and locate events of forensic interest.

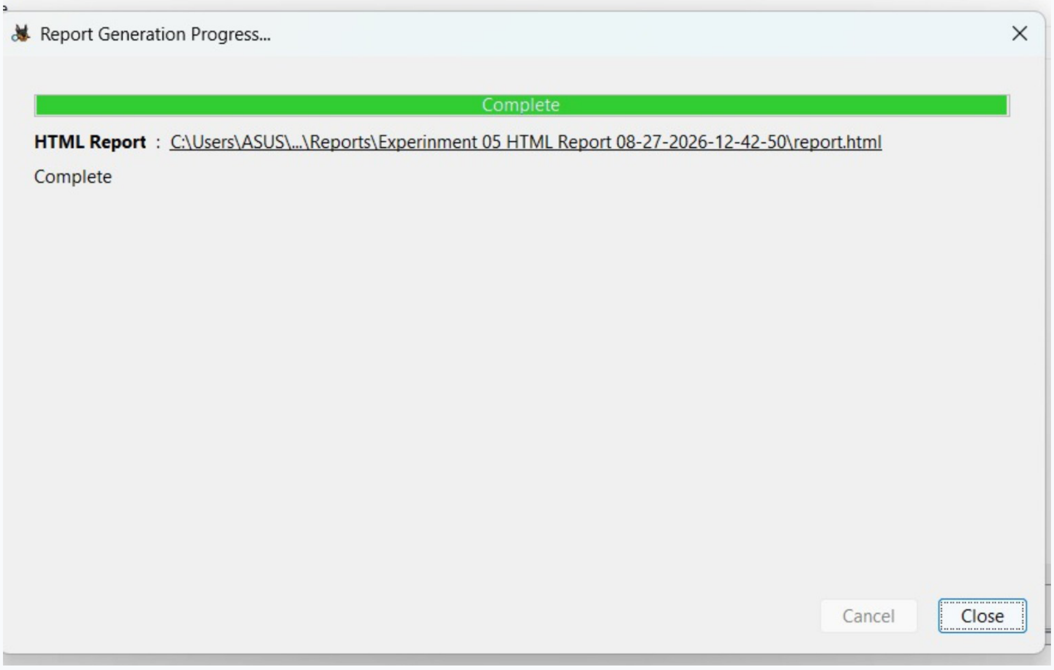
Forensic significance: The processing stage marks the transition from configuration to actual evidence analysis. Completion and database registration make the processed artefacts available for subsequent examination within the case. Timeline analysis is useful when investigators need to reconstruct activity in chronological order. Filtering and event review can help connect files, user activity, and other artefacts to a sequence of events.

Output 10 - Generate Report: Select HTML Report



The Generate Report window allows the examiner to select a reporting format. The **HTML Report** option provides a structured presentation of analysed results and tagged artefacts for review and formal forensic documentation.

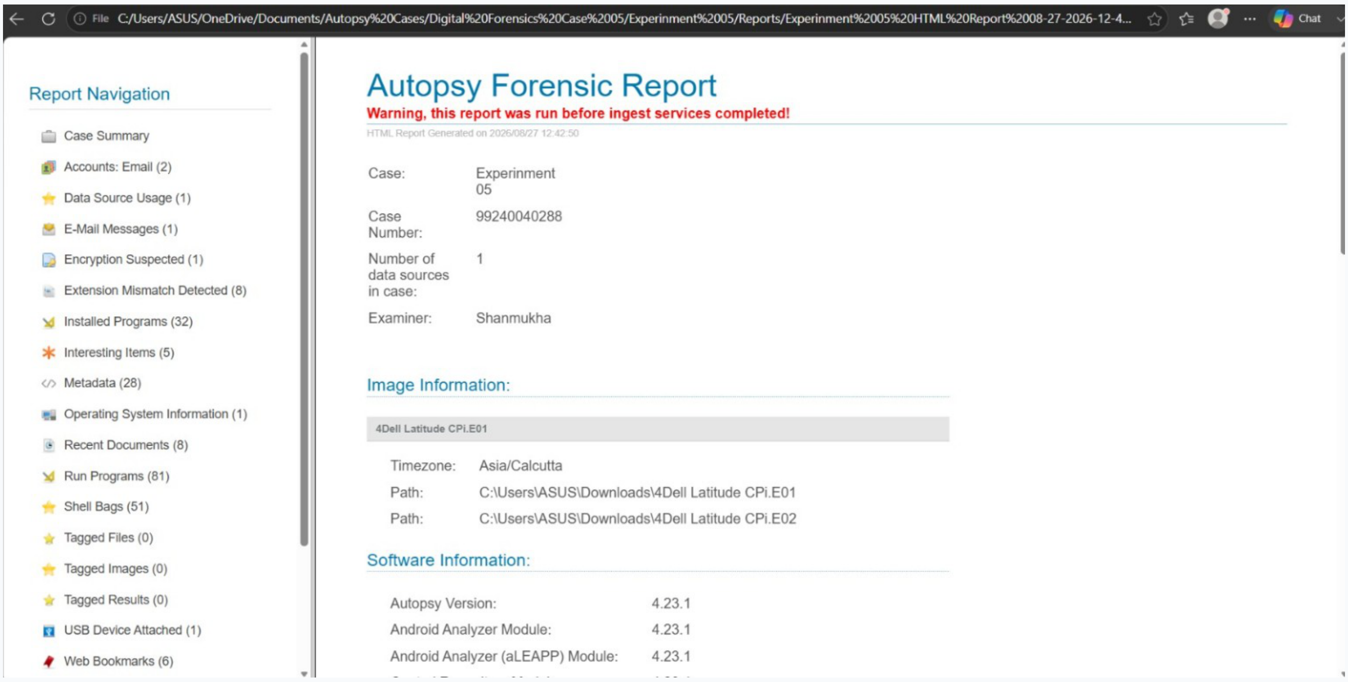
Output 11 - Report Generation Completed



This output confirms completion of report generation and displays the destination of the generated **HTML report**. The completed report can be opened for detailed review of the case findings and processed evidence.

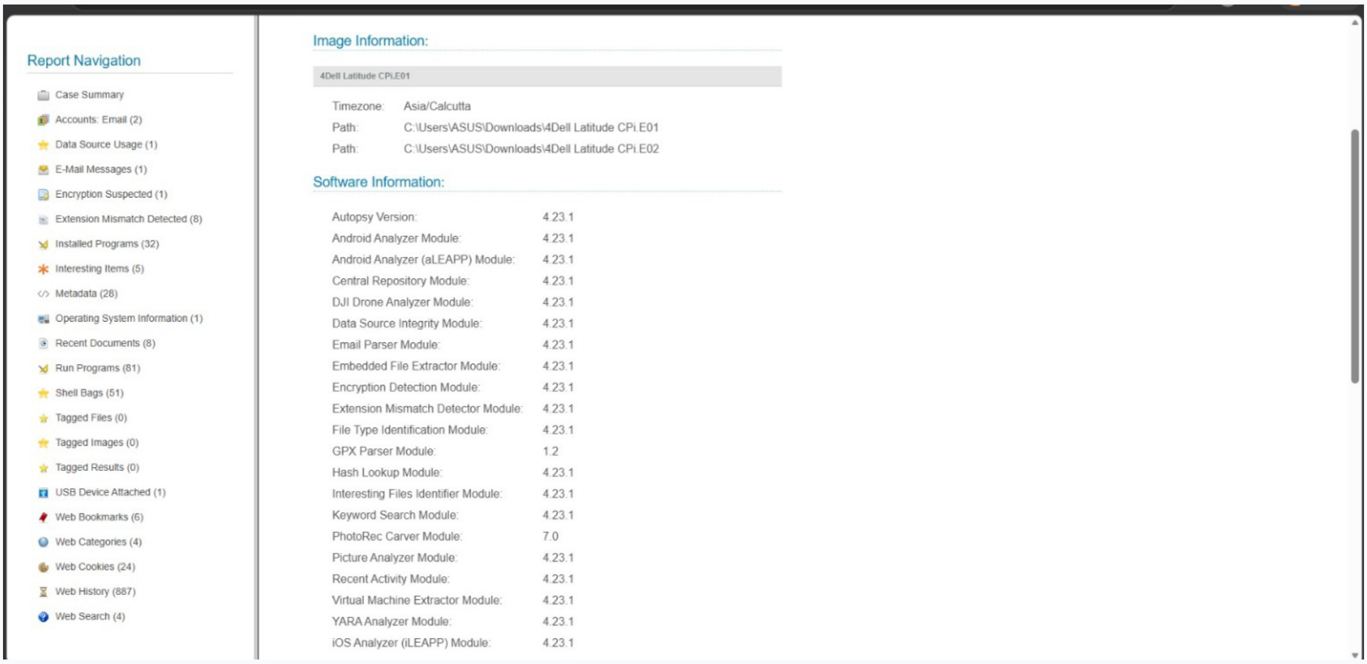
Forensic significance: A structured report preserves important findings in a form that can be reviewed outside the live analysis interface. HTML reporting is therefore useful for documentation, presentation, and repeatable case review. A completed report confirms that the reporting stage has finished and provides a usable output location. This becomes a practical handoff point for documentation and evidence review.

Output 12 - Final Autopsy Forensic Report



The Final **Autopsy Forensic Report** consolidates case details, examiner information, image information, and analysed artefacts. Its navigation panel provides organised access to multiple categories of forensic results.

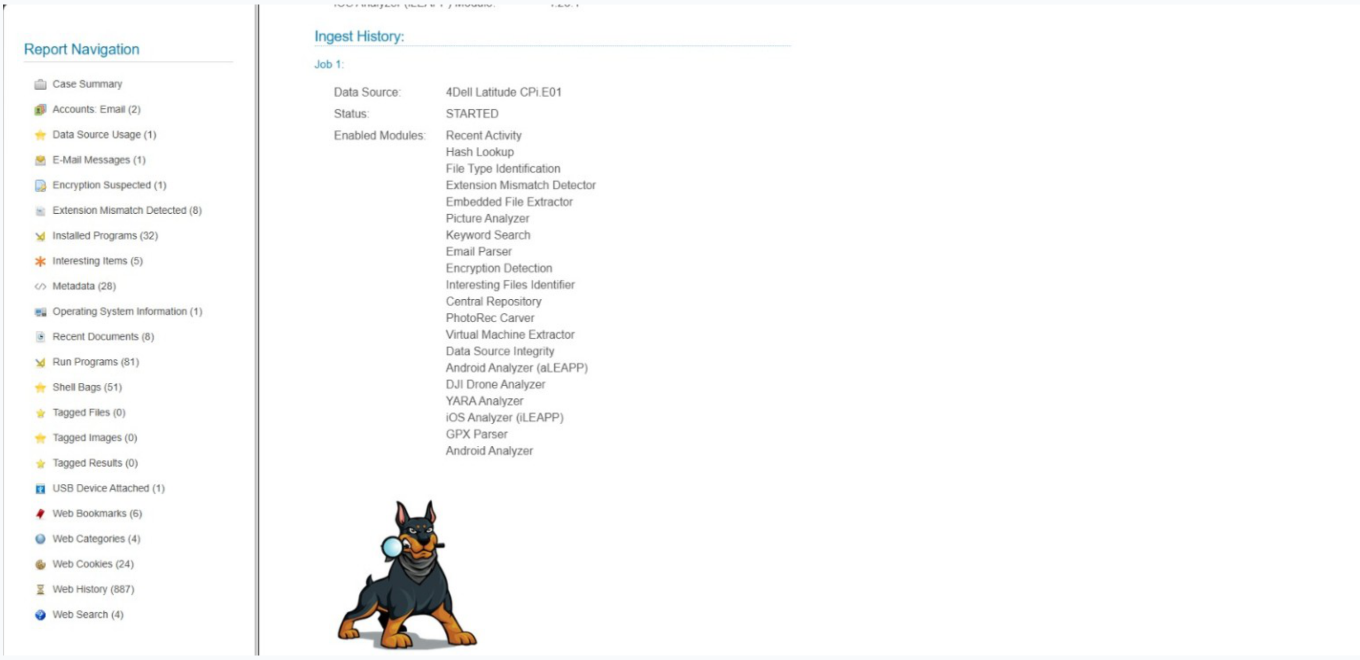
Output 13 - Image Information and Software Information



The Image Information and Software Information sections document the evidence image paths, time zone, Autopsy version, and analyzer modules. Recording these details supports reproducibility and makes the forensic processing environment identifiable.

Forensic significance: The final report brings together administrative information and forensic results. The navigation categories help an examiner move from general case information to specific artefacts and activity identified during processing. Recording image and software information provides context for the examination. These details help explain which evidence sources and analysis modules produced the results contained in the forensic report.

Output 14 - Ingest History and Report Navigation



Ingest History and Report Navigation records the processing job, source data, status, and enabled modules. This creates an auditable record of how the digital evidence moved through the Autopsy workflow before the final report was reviewed.

Observation

The screenshots document the complete Autopsy workflow from creating a forensic case and recording examiner information to importing disk-image evidence, configuring ingest modules, reviewing timeline activity, and generating an HTML forensic report. Each stage contributes to structured processing and review of the supplied digital evidence.

Result

A forensic case was created in Autopsy and the supplied digital evidence was imported for analysis. The data source was processed using configured ingest modules, timeline information was reviewed, and an HTML forensic report was generated for documentation.

Conclusion

This experiment demonstrates the practical use of Autopsy for digital forensics. It highlights the importance of accurate case documentation, controlled evidence ingestion, systematic artefact analysis, timeline review, and structured forensic reporting in a repeatable investigation.

Key forensic keywords

Autopsy | forensic case | digital evidence | data source | ingest | timeline analysis | HTML report | forensic report | evidence processing | report navigation